

Standard Chess

8×8

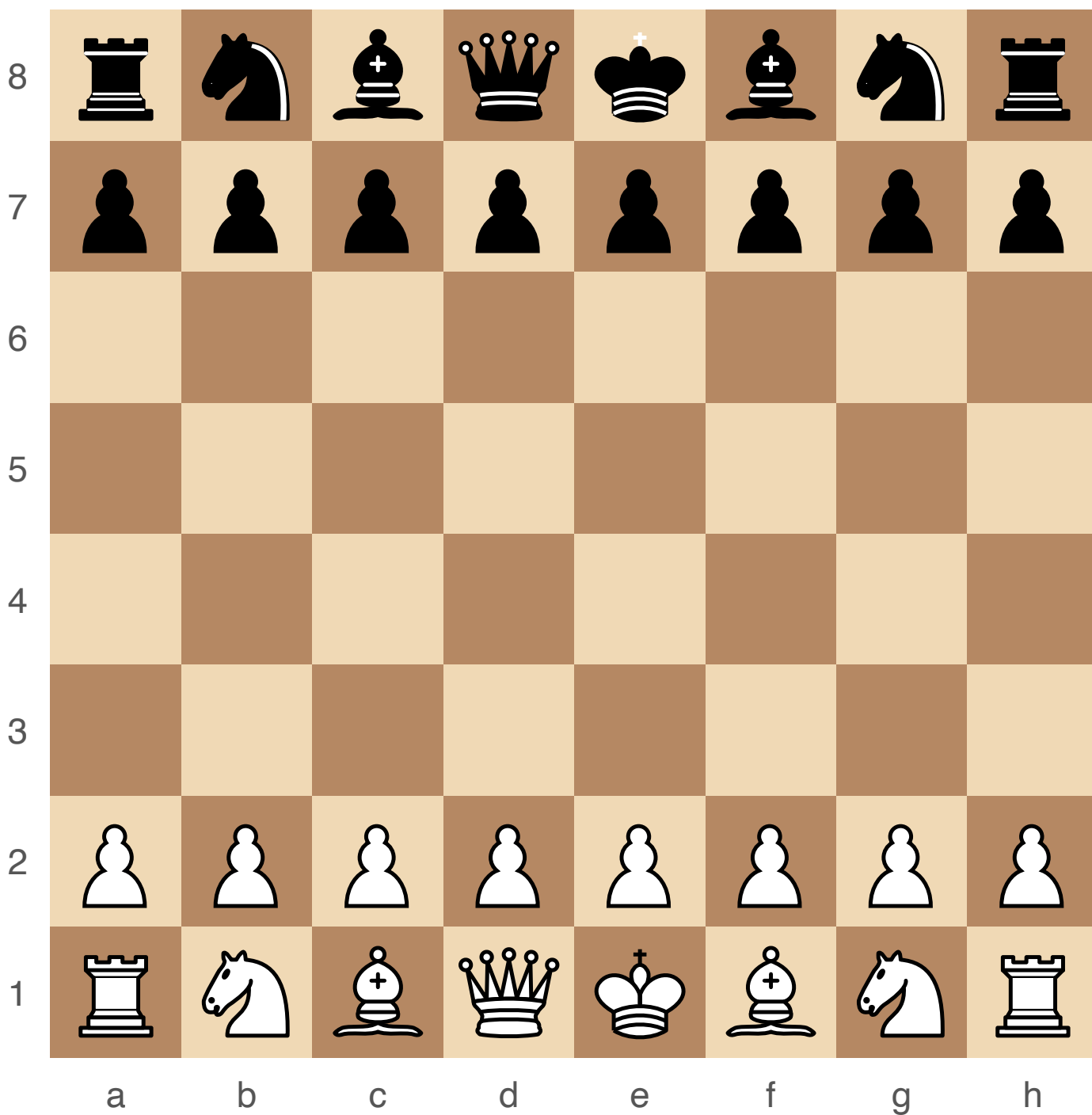
BOARD

2

PLAYERS

STANDARD CHESS

Classic FIDE rules. The foundation from which all variants diverge.



Standard Chess — starting position

SETUP

Board: 8×8, 64 squares alternating light/dark.

PIECES

Pieces (per side): 1 King, 1 Queen, 2 Rooks, 2 Bishops, 2 Knights, 8 Pawns.

Setup: White on ranks 1–2, Black on ranks 7–8. Back rank (from a-file): Rook, Knight, Bishop, Queen, King, Bishop, Knight, Rook. Pawns fill the second rank.

FEN: `rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/RNBQKBNR w KQkq - 0 1`

RULES

All standard FIDE rules: pieces move as defined, turns alternate, captures remove the opponent's piece. Special moves: castling (kingside/queenside), en passant capture, and pawn promotion on the eighth rank.

WIN CONDITION

Checkmate the opponent's King, or opponent resigns. Draws by stalemate, threefold repetition, fifty-move rule, or insufficient material.

STRATEGY

Control the centre, develop pieces early, castle for King safety, and coordinate piece activity. The opening, middlegame, and endgame each demand different skills — billions of games have been played and the game remains unsolved.

ATTRIBUTION

Origins in 6th-century India (Chaturanga). Modern rules standardised by FIDE. Public domain.